

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 35

By Atchley

A RESOLUTION to recognize emergency telecommunicators as first responders.

WHEREAS, emergency telecommunicators are part of the critical infrastructure of the public safety system and are trained as certified dispatchers; and

WHEREAS, emergency telecommunicators play a critical role in emergency response as the first line of communications for people needing law enforcement, fire, or medical response and are, very often, the first public safety employees handling the emergency situation; and

WHEREAS, emergency telecommunicators are a lifeline to law enforcement, fire, and medical responders in the field; and

WHEREAS, information gathered and relayed by emergency telecommunicators plays an integral and effective role in the public safety response; and

WHEREAS, emergency telecommunicators handle both emergency and non-emergency calls professionally and efficiently, handling stressful situations while delivering emergency instructions and lifesaving details; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize that the emergency telecommunicators of Tennessee are first responders in this State and should be recognized as such in state policy and procedural considerations.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the General Assembly wishes to extend its gratitude to the emergency telecommunicators of this State for their tireless work to ensure the safety and health of all Tennesseans.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.